MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-BBA (HONOURS)REGULAR/IMPROVEMENT/REAPPEARANCE

EXAMINATION NOVEMBER 2025

FIRST SEMESTER

Core Course(CC)-MG1CCRBBA103-BUSINESS COMMUNICATION-1

2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS

Duration 1.5 Hours **Maximum Marks:50**

Part A

Short Essay Type Questions-Answer any 2-Each carries 5 marks (2x5=10)

1. How would you define communication? Explain the role and relevance of business communication in a corporate setting with an example of its impact on decision-making. *(5 Marks)*

Definition:

Communication is the process of exchanging ideas, information, and messages between individuals or groups to create understanding.

Role and Relevance in Business Communication:

- Facilitates Decision-Making: Clear communication ensures managers receive accurate data to make informed decisions.
- Improves Coordination: Departments can work together smoothly through effective communication channels.
- Enhances Employee Productivity: Proper instructions and feedback help employees perform efficiently.
- Builds Relationships: Transparent communication strengthens trust among employees and management.

❖ Ensures Problem Solving: Misunderstandings can be resolved quickly through open communication.

Example:

If the marketing team communicates accurate market survey results to management, the company can decide whether to launch a new product or modify its features. Poor communication may result in wrong decisions and financial loss.

2. During a coffee break, you overhear a colleague sharing unverified information about a competitor's new product launch. Others are adding their thoughts. How can the grapevine impact the accuracy of information being shared among employees? Explain the potential consequences of spreading unverified gossip in the workplace. *(5 Marks)*

Impact of Grapevine on Accuracy:

- The grapevine is informal communication and often distorts information as it passes from person to person.
- Messages can become exaggerated, incomplete, or completely false.
- Personal bias or assumptions may be added, reducing accuracy further.

Potential Consequences of Spreading Unverified Gossip:

◆ Misunderstanding and Confusion: Employees may believe false information and react unnecessarily.

◆ Damage to Organizational Culture: Gossip creates a negative atmosphere and reduces trust.

◆ Poor Decision-Making: Managers may take wrong actions based on inaccurate information.

◆ Lower Employee Morale: Rumours cause stress, anxiety, and insecurity among staff.

◆ Conflict and Miscommunication: Unverified gossip can create conflicts between teams or individuals.

3. How does blended communication enhance collaboration in a virtual work environment? Analyse its advantages and limitations.*(5 Marks)*

Meaning of Blended Communication:

Blended communication combines **traditional in-person methods** with **digital communication tools** (email, video meetings, chat platforms) to improve workplace collaboration.

Enhancement of Collaboration:

- Enables employees to communicate anytime and from anywhere.
- Supports teamwork through tools like Zoom, Google Meet, Teams, and WhatsApp groups.
- Maintains personal connection through occasional face-to-face interaction.

Advantages:

1. **Flexibility:** Employees can choose the most effective mode of communication.
2. **Improved Teamwork:** Collaboration tools support group discussions and document sharing.
3. **Cost and Time Efficient:** Reduces travel and meeting costs.
4. **Better Engagement:** Mix of online and offline methods keeps communication lively.
5. **Higher Productivity:** Quick responses and organized communication channels.

Limitations:

1. **Technical Issues:** Internet failures or device problems disrupt communication.
2. **Misinterpretation:** Lack of face-to-face cues may lead to misunderstanding.
3. **Overload of Digital Tools:** Too many apps or messages can cause stress.
4. **Security Risks:** Data breaches and cyber threats.
5. **Lack of Personal Touch:** Virtual communication may reduce emotional connection.

4. List and describe the core concepts of media literacy.*(5 Marks)*

Media literacy refers to the ability to access, analyse, evaluate, create, and communicate information in various media forms.

Core Concepts:

- All Media Messages Are Constructed:
  Media content is carefully created using images, words, editing, and design. Nothing is natural or accidental.
- Media Use Creative Language:
  Media uses specific techniques—camera angles, sound, colour, fonts—to influence audience perception.
- Different People Interpret Media Differently:
  Audiences understand messages based on their age, culture, experience, and beliefs.
- Media Have Embedded Values and Biases:
  Every media message carries certain values, opinions, and assumptions that may influence the audience.
- Media Are Created for Purpose (Profit or Power):
  Most media content is produced to attract viewers, generate profit, or influence public opinion.

Part B

Essay Type-Answer any 2-Each question carries 10 marks (2x10=20)

5. How does the tone of a message influence the relationship between the communicator and the audience? Provide an example of a courteous versus an abrupt message*(10 Marks)*

Introduction

Tone refers to the attitude, emotion, or feeling conveyed through the words used in a message. In business communication, the tone can be formal, friendly, polite, respectful, or sometimes rude and abrupt. The tone of a message plays a major role in shaping how the audience receives, interprets, and responds to communication.

Influence of Tone on the Communicator–Audience Relationship

a. Builds or Breaks Trust

b. Creates Positive or Negative Impressions

c. Enhances Cooperation

d. Reduces Misunderstandings

e. Improves Workplace Culture

f. Encourages Open Communication

g. Influences Motivation and Performance

Importance of Using Courteous Tone in Business Messages

- Reflects professionalism and respect
- Helps to avoid conflict
- Ensures message clarity
- Strengthens long-term relationships
- Encourages feedback and two-way communication
- Improves organizational harmony

Example of Courteous vs Abrupt Message

Courteous Message (Polite Tone):

"Dear Team,
Please submit your monthly reports by 4 PM today so that we can complete the final compilation on time. Let me know if anyone needs assistance.
Thank you for your cooperation."

Abrupt Message (Rude Tone):

"Submit your reports by 4 PM today. Don't delay."

Difference:

- The courteous message shows respect, clarity, and team spirit.
- The abrupt message sounds commanding, impolite, and creates pressure or resentment.

Conclusion

The tone of a message is a powerful element in communication. It determines how the audience perceives the communicator and how effectively the message is received. Using a courteous, respectful, and positive tone encourages cooperation, builds strong relationships, and supports a productive workplace. On the other hand, an abrupt or rude tone can weaken trust, create conflict, and damage communication effectiveness.

6. The finance department is tasked with presenting the company's quarterly financial results to stakeholders. The data is complex and requires clear communication to facilitate decision-making. What specific elements of presentation skills should the finance team emphasize to communicate complex financial data effectively? How can they use infographics to enhance clarity and ensure that stakeholders grasp the key insights?*(10 Marks)*

Introduction

Financial presentations involve large amounts of numerical and analytical information. To help stakeholders make informed decisions, the finance team must use effective presentation skills, simplify complex data, and ensure clarity.

Key Elements of Presentation Skills for Financial Data

a. Clarity and Simplicity

b. Logical Structure

c. Accuracy and Reliability

d. Use of Visual Aids

e. Audience Awareness

f. Effective Verbal Communication

g. Confidence and Professionalism

Using Infographics to Enhance Clarity

a. Convert Complex Numbers into Visual Summaries

b. Highlight Key Insights

c. Improve Engagement

d. Support Decision-Making

e. Comparison Charts

Conclusion

Effective presentation skills combined with well-designed infographics enable the finance team to communicate complex financial data clearly. This enhances understanding, supports decision-making, and ensures stakeholders grasp key insights quickly and accurately.

7. Describe the common barriers that can interfere with effective team communication. Suggest various measures to overcome them.*(10 Marks)*

Introduction

Team communication is essential for collaboration, productivity, and achieving organisational goals. However, several barriers can prevent smooth information exchange.

Common Barriers to Effective Team Communication

a. Physical Barriers

Distance, poor workspace layout, noise, and lack of face-to-face interaction can obstruct communication.

b. Language Barriers

Use of difficult vocabulary, accents, or unfamiliar terms leads to misunderstanding.

c. Psychological Barriers

Stress, fear, lack of confidence, personality differences, and emotional biases affect communication.

d. Cultural and Social Barriers

Different customs, values, or communication styles may lead to misinterpretation.

e. Technological Barriers

Poor internet connectivity, software issues, or unfamiliar tools hinder communication in virtual teams.

f. Perceptual Barriers

Team members may interpret messages differently based on beliefs or past experiences.

g. Organisational Barriers

Rigid hierarchy, poor leadership, and unclear roles disrupt information flow.

Measures to Overcome Communication Barriers

a. Encourage Open Communication

Promote discussions, feedback, and active listening to reduce misunderstandings.

b. Use Simple and Clear Language

Avoid complex words; use straightforward sentences and examples.

c. Provide Training

Workshops on communication skills, cultural sensitivity, and technology usage improve team interactions.

d. Improve Physical and Virtual Workspaces

Design better office layouts, provide noise-free areas, and use reliable communication tools.

e. Foster Emotional Intelligence

Encourage empathy, patience, and respect within the team to minimize psychological barriers.

f. Clarify Roles and Expectations

Clear job responsibilities reduce confusion and improve coordination.

g. Encourage Feedback Mechanisms

Feedback loops help correct misunderstandings quickly.

Conclusion

By understanding and addressing communication barriers, organisations can improve teamwork

8.Analyse the Role of a Personal Website in Building a Professional Brand.*(10 Marks)*

A **personal website** is one of the most powerful tools for building and strengthening a professional brand in the digital age. It acts as a centralized platform where an individual can present their identity, skills, achievements, and expertise to a global audience. Unlike social media profiles, a personal website offers more control, customization, and credibility. The following points explain its role in detail:

1. Establishes a Unique Professional Identity

2. Enhances Credibility and Trust

3. Showcases Skills and Portfolio

4. Provides Full Control Over Content

5. Acts as a Digital Resume and Profile

6. Improves Online Visibility and Reach

7. Enables Thought Leadership

8. Facilitates Networking and Communication

9. Supports Career Growth and Opportunities

10. Builds a Long-Term Personal Brand

Conclusion

In conclusion, a personal website plays a transformative role in building a professional brand. It not only enhances visibility and credibility but also allows individuals to present their skills, experience, and personality in a compelling way. In today's competitive environment, having a personal website is an essential strategy for career development and long-term professional success.

Part C

Letter Writing-Compulsory Question-20 marks

9.Write a letter seeking a position as a software developer at a tech startup*(20 Marks)*

It may be in the form of a *covering letter and resume* OR *Letter style application*

Covering letter may include

- Heading
- Date
- Inside address
- Salutation
- Subjectline
- Body of letter
- Complimentary close
- Signature
- Enclosures

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